

Chapter 124-5

Xu Qingzhu's tears fell onto Chen Liuying's hand, even flowing over that sharp knife. Chen Liuying wiped the back of her hand, then curved her lips into a smile: "Baby, you're scared already?"

Xu Qingzhu still couldn't speak.

Seemingly finding it boring to talk to herself, Chen Liuying reached out and ripped the tape off her mouth. But the knife landed by her lips as she said in a strange tone: "Baby, keep your voice down. If you're too loud... I'll get angry, and then my knife might slip across your face. If you're not pretty anymore, I won't like you."

Xu Qingzhu's lips were parched. When the tape was violently ripped off, some dead skin was torn from her lips as well. But when facing a life-threatening situation, this small injury was insignificant.

She asked hoarsely: "What do you want?"

This was already the maximum rationality she could maintain.

The other party laughed: "What I want... is very simple. I just want... you all to DIE!"

By the time she said those last two words, her tone had changed, carrying an indescribable anger.

"Do we have a grudge?" Xu Qingzhu's voice trembled, but her fingers dug tightly into her own palm, trying her best not to be afraid, creating an opportunity for herself to have an equal dialogue with the kidnapper.

But how could she not be afraid?

In this kind of environment, all the frightening memories were triggered. Those memories she thought she had already forgotten were stirred up again, only to find that every scene was so vivid.

She desperately suppressed them... suppressed them...

"You ruined me." Chen Liuying's voice became increasingly strange, tinged with madness. Although she was smiling, she was using the smile to mask her anger: "Baby, you ruined me. My entire life was destroyed by you."

"Do you know how hard I worked to get all that? Do you know how hard I worked to climb above my class? People like you who were born with everything don't understand, but you can so easily destroy all that effort." Chen Liuying pressed the knife closer to her face, inadvertently breaking the skin.

Xu Qingzhu felt a stinging pain on her face and instinctively drew in a sharp breath.

Chen Liuying sneered: "Baby, so you can still feel pain? Oh, I forgot—you're a delicate little princess that no one can touch, provoke, or get close to. So what? Now you're in my hands. I actually quite like you."

The heat from Chen Liuying's breath spilled entirely onto Xu Qingzhu's face.

Xu Qingzhu smelled a strong scent of alcohol.

She only remembered receiving a phone call in her office, saying that flowers had been delivered downstairs. She had thought they were from Liang Shi, and when she received the call, a flash of joy passed through her heart.

It wasn't any special occasion, yet she could receive little romantic gestures from Liang Shi.

Xu Qingzhu hadn't thought too much at the time. She went downstairs without even putting on her coat. Then she received another call saying it was on the other side, so she followed the phone's directions. But just as she turned a corner, something was injected directly into the back of her neck, and she lost consciousness.

She never would have imagined that this person would be so bold as to do such a thing in broad daylight, in such a bustling area.

Xu Qingzhu didn't know where she had been taken, but it should still be within Haizhou City.

She didn't know who the other party was, let alone what they wanted.

She was currently in a state of complete ignorance while facing a threat to her life.

Fundamentally speaking, she and the kidnapper were on unequal footing.

All Xu Qingzhu could do was stall... stall for time.

To see if anyone would notice she was missing, if anyone would come to save her.

"Is this how you show you like someone?" Xu Qingzhu countered lightly, "Why don't I feel any of your affection?"

The other party was momentarily at a loss for words.

A moment later, Chen Liuying directly removed the black cloth covering her eyes. Her eyes could see light again, and her fear wasn't as heavy anymore. Some rationality returned.

When she saw it was Chen Liuying, Xu Qingzhu was only slightly surprised.

What surprised her was that Chen Liuying could kidnap her single-handedly. What was expected was that Chen Liuying would do something this insane.

"You don't seem very surprised." Chen Liuying said, "Do you think I can't see your expression?"

"What expression do you want to see from me?" Xu Qingzhu lowered her brows and eyes: "Anyway, I've already fallen into your hands. What do you want to do? Want money or revenge? Do you want to take revenge on me, or do you want to kill me?"

The earlier words still had some trembling, letting one hear her fear, but the last three words were spoken fearlessly.

Compared to the former, she was very calm about the latter.

But Chen Liuying put away the knife, the motion slow and deliberate. She scoffed: "Baby, how could I bear to kill you?"

Her finger traced along Xu Qingzhu's jawline. Her somewhat long fingernails suddenly pinched lightly on Xu Qingzhu's delicate face. She gripped Xu Qingzhu's chin forcefully, forcing her to raise her head and look at her: "Xu Qingzhu, I want... to let you see how the person you love suffers in agony."

Chen Liuying flung her chin away, nearly dislocating Xu Qingzhu's jaw.

At that moment, Xu Qingzhu even briefly thought with dark humor: Good thing this chin is real.

But when she heard the latter half of that sentence, her expression changed. "Chen Liuying."

Xu Qingzhu called her name very seriously: "What happened back then was my doing. If you want revenge, come to me."

"I refuse." Chen Liuying sat casually on a higher surface, looking down at her from above: "I like to torture people slowly, to let you all experience the pain I felt that day."

Those vicious PR tactics had plunged her from a heart full of joy into an endless abyss.

She would make all these people taste it.

Just as she finished speaking, Xu Qingzhu's phone lit up. Chen Liuying picked up the phone and played the voice message.

It was Liang Shi's voice, panting for breath.

She said: "I'm here. Where are you?"

Hearing this, Xu Qingzhu's heart felt inexplicably heavy.

Xu Qingzhu only hoped that Liang Shi's future life would be flowers and red carpets, a broad and smooth path.

All the painful memories could stay vivid in her own mind, becoming indelible marks in her own life.

She thought: Liang Shi, don't remember, don't recall.

—Those embarrassing, dark, painful memories—let them disappear from your life.

—Please, please don't remember them.